

RETURN GRANT



WHAT IS RETURN GRANT

Fully funded research fellowship/grant for up to 36 months at the CZU

For researchers returning after research career break of min. 180 days due to the maternity/paternity leave, long - term care (incl. child up to 5 years old) or illness (Exceptions apply in cases of part-time research work during the career break.)

Applicants: Ph.D. student - Junior (up to 7 years from Ph.D.) - Senior



APPLICATION

Online- [HERE](#)

Opening: 1 December 2025

Deadline: 31 January 2026

PROJECT PROPOSAL

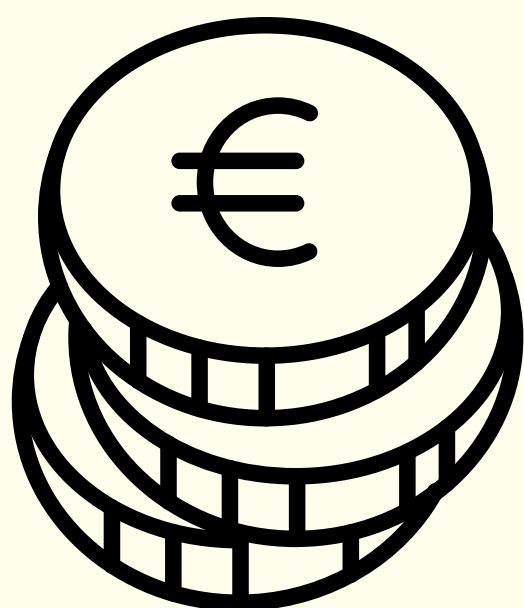
Mentor from CZU

PI: Senior/Junior/Ph.D. student

Technical project proposal

Alignment with the OP JAK strategies

Budget proposal



FUNDING

PI: Gross Salary from 53 000 resp. 67 000 CZK/month

Travel budget for up to 6 months

Research budget

Budget for training/education

Research Team: Up to 0,2 FTE for mentor

Up to 2 FTE for the research team

OVERALL BUDGET UP TO app. 10 Million CZK



Co-funded by
the European Union



Returns to the CZU

On December 1, 2025, the Czech University of Life Sciences (CZU) launched a call for applications for Return Grants. The call is implemented within the project “Returns to CZU,” registration number CZ.02.01.01/00/24_037/0013835, supported by the Operational Programme Johannes Amos Comenius.

For who is the Return Grant?

The eligible applicant (main researcher) for the Return Grant is a researcher returning to active work in research and development (R&D) after a career break, or for whom no more than 12 months have passed since his/her return at the time of submitting the Return Grant application.

What is a career break?

A career break is a period of at least 180 consecutive calendar days during which the researcher (the applicant for the Return Grant) was unable to carry out research and development (R&D) activities in full due to maternity or parental leave, long-term care responsibilities, or long-term illness. The career break may be interrupted for periods when the personal obstacle temporarily ceased. It is permitted for the researcher to perform R&D activities during the career break under an employment relationship with the beneficiary, up to 0.3 FTE per month on average, calculated over the number of months during which such work was carried out. However, in no individual month may the researcher's R&D engagement during the career break exceed 0.5 FTE.

What can I gain through the Return Grant?

- Funding for your own research in the form of a main researcher position at 0.5–1.0 FTE
- Collaboration with a mentor at 0.2 FTE (especially if the main researcher is a junior researcher or PhD student)
- Support expert team (optional, up to 4 people with a total workload of max. 2.0 FTE)
- Mobility of the main researcher (optional, for 1–6 months)
- Further education of the main researcher
- Contribution for the care of a child or close person

Employees of CZU can also use the extended capacity of the university childcare group **Poníček**, which provides care for children from 2 years of age.



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Czech University
of Life Sciences Prague

The Return Grant duration must be between 12 and 36 months

When can I submit a Return Grant application?

Opening date for applications: December 1, 2025

Closing date for applications: January 31, 2026

Where to submit the Return Grant application?

Electronically: [Kurz: Submitting grant applications in English | Projekty ČZU](#)

In paper form: including all required attachments to the designated faculty Return Grant officer

When can I start implementing the Return Grant?

Předpokládané zahájení realizace podpořených grantů 1. 5. 2026

By when must the grant be completed?

Completion of supported grants no later than April 30, 2029

Where can I find more information?

[Czech University of Life Sciences Prague](#)

Contacts

For any questions, please contact the designated faculty Return Grant officer at the faculty where you are submitting your application.

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